

Graphics

You need to have, at least, a DirectX 9 capable graphics device. Such devices have also been available for quite some time now – they became widely available way back in 2004-05. Windows 7 and Windows Vista had the same minimum graphics requirement. If you're running any of them, your machine's graphics capabilities should be sound enough.

Display

As low as 1024 x 768 pixels will do and most people have way more than that!

Input devices

As obvious as it sounds, you need a keyboard and a mouse. If you want to use touch features, you need a device which has a touch-enabled screen. In fact, a touch-enabled screen can perceptibly enhance your Windows 8 experience.

Storage Space

This shouldn't be a problem in this age of massive hard disks. If you have the 32-bit OS, 16 GB should do, while 20 GB for the 64-bit version is recommended. That said, the installation would typically take up 8 GB and 10 GB of space, respectively, for 32-bit and 64-bit installations.

Extra features

Secure boot: It needs motherboard firmware with support for UEFI v2.3.1 and has the Microsoft Windows Certification Authority in the UEFI signature database.

- ▶ **SkyDrive:** Since it's a cloud offering by Microsoft, you're required to have a Microsoft account (which is free, of course).
- ▶ **BitLocker:** You would need a TPM (Trusted Platform Module) chip in your system to encrypt the OS installation drive.
- ▶ **Hyper-V:** It's an enterprise class virtualization solution which requires a 64-bit system with SLAT (Second Level Address Translation) support.
- ▶ **Snap apps:** Snap apps is a feature that gives you an overview of the list of Modern UI apps running on the system while you're in desktop mode and the list of desktop apps when you're using a Modern UI app. You need at least 1366 x 768 pixels for the feature, and that can be a problem. Many laptop models sold in the past had a resolution of 1200 x 800 and a number of them are still in use today. While the height (800